

Network Neutrality

Network neutrality is the principle that Internet users should be in control of what content they view and what applications they use on the Internet. According to an article by Marguerite Reardon, net neutrality is “the principle that all content transmitted over a cable or a phone company’s network be treated equally and without preference.” Net neutrality does not allow a network operator to favor the transmission of their own or affiliated content or services. They would also not allow a network operator to act as gatekeepers on which can provide content or services, also not to discriminate against unaffiliated content and services in the allocation of transmission capacity, or to force consumers to buy unwanted content and services in order to obtain basic transmission services. What some mean by net neutrality is the reinstatement of the basic legal requirements that the Internet was founded on, which are: nondiscrimination, interconnection on reasonable terms and conditions, service upon reasonable request, the right to attach devices to the network, and the right to innovate and provide service without having to obtain the permission of the network operator. In my discussion on net neutrality I will describe the basics of net neutrality and how far it should go.

Net neutrality is a major issue as the U.S. considers new telecommunications laws. Marguerite Reardon’s article “Thanks to BitTorrent, Net neutrality debate reignites” brings up that even Sen. Barack Obama said that net neutrality would be high on his list of priorities if he

makes it into office. Common Cause, a nonprofit organization founded in 1970 by John Gardner, believes “net neutrality is the reason this democratic medium has grown exponentially, fueled innovation, and altered how we communicate.” There is some truth in this, because even I have noticed that there have become some tight holds on what one can do when communicating, whether it’s on a cell phone or online. I have seen that more and more charges are being put on services that were once virtually free, but some believe that this is the way things should be done.

There are many ways in which a network can discriminate and all include in some form or another, making money. Some believe that neutrality should be enforced as soon as possible. One of those people is Tim Wu, a professor at Columbia University Law School who says “the broadband market is really at an inflection point. And it’s important to establish laws now because it will essentially set the ground rules for how the market will play out in the future.” I agree because without these laws enforcing net neutrality the web along with other major communication companies could completely take over communication links, enforcing high rates for the use of their services. It can also be said limiting services is wrong as well. In one article it mentions that “net neutrality supporters say neither Comcast nor any other service provider should selectively limit any particular type of traffic.” Just like the government regulates Microsoft on how much they can dominate their competition, net neutrality is needed for the same reasons. A number of big name companies have been questioned due to actions taken on their parts including Comcast, Verizon, and AT&T. The Associated Press says that they carried out experiments proving that “Comcast prevented some users from uploading content to peer-to-peer networks including BitTorrent.”

To ensure that the Internet we have today continues to grow and flourish, there are several other discriminatory tactics that need to be addressed. Attachment of devices is a concept that refers to the ability to attach devices to a transmission network. Telephone network users generally have the right to attach any device to the network without obtaining the network operator's permission so long as the device will not harm the network or other users of the network and conforms to certain minimal specifications. The ability to attach devices without approval or interference from the network operator is essential for continued innovation. Another discrimination tactic is port blocking which is a term used to describe a specific form of discrimination in which the network operator uses information in the message header which tells the receiving computer which software application to use to open the information. The computer knows which software to use by the "port" through which the message enters the computer's communications hardware. If a network operator wishes to block a particular application it can do so by blocking messages destined for the port used by that application. One last discriminatory tactic is caching which is a term that refers to the local storage of information that is frequently requested by an end user. Caching arises as an issue in net neutrality discussions in two ways. First, because caching must be done on devices located closer to the end user, in general these devices are physically located in a facility under the control of the local network operator. In the alternative, if the caching is done at a physical location not under the network operator's control, then the local storage device needs to be interconnected with the local network. As a result, in the absence of a right for competitors to physically collocate equipment or to interconnect with a local network, a network operator could use local caching to favor their own content and services. These are just a few discriminatory tactics that need to be carefully monitored to insure the future of net neutrality.

Net neutrality should be enforced to the point where service providers can't take advantage of their customers, but they are also allowed to run a fair and competitive business. The principal of net neutrality should be enforced through moral thoughts, then again when money gets involved few people think of the right thing to do.

Works Cited

Common Cause. "Net Neutrality."

<http://www.commoncause.org/site/pp.asp?c=dkLNK1MQIwG&b=1421497>.

Reardon, Marguerite. "Thanks to BitTorrent, Net neutrality debate reignites." November 2, 2007. CNET News. http://news.cnet.com/Thanks-to-BitTorrent%2C-Net-neutrality-debate-reignites/2100-1034_3-6216750.html?tag=nw.7.

Jezreel Wilson

Prof. Underwood

Coins 333

3 February 2009

Grade: 85

Piracy Ethics Paper

The copyright right laws in the U.S. originate from the Copyright Act which was amended in 1976 and was intended for the sole purpose of protecting the works and inventions of brilliant minds. Due to the expansion of the internet the opportunity for theft and misuse of intellectual property can be out of control. The writer of "Software Copyright Laws", Brian Scott says, that "one of the biggest hitches why many software businesses go out of business is they have difficulty enforcing software copyright laws and getting money that is owed to them from end users". This is where the copyright laws come into play.

For any work that I publish it is under protection by the copyright right laws as long as it is original, which according to Mark F. Radcliffe and Diane Brinson in their article "Copyright Law", means "if it owes its origin to the author and was not copied from some preexisting work." My work could contain preexisting if "the copyright on the new work covers only the original material contributed by the author." The article also lists the 5 exclusive rights give by the Copyright Act. The first is the Reproduction Right, which gives the copyright owner the "right to copy, duplicate, transcribe, or imitate the work in fixed form." The next is the modification right or derivative works right, which gives the copyright owner "the right to modify the work to create a new work." The third is the distribution right which gives the

copyright owner “the right to distribute copies of the work to the public by sale, rental, lease, or lending.” Another is the public performance right which gives the copyright owner “the right to recite, play, dance, act, or show the work at public place or to transmit it to the public,” which is normally focused on motion pictures and audiovisual works. The last of the exclusive rights is the public display right which gives the copyright owner “the right to show a copy of the work directly or by means of a film, slide, or television image at a public place or to transmit it to the public.” These are the rights given to me through the copyright laws of the U.S.

Even though there are laws in the U.S. there are still ideals by developers like myself who would like to set in order to improve our profit. The number one issue would be to determine the price of my product. As much as I would like to believe in laissez-faire, limit of government from all aspects of society, in order to set a price that would make me an automatic millionaire, the government sometimes gets involved with how much a developer can charge for their product.

Another issue would be the use of my product. I would limit the amount of times my product could be installed. I would sell my products in packs for home and businesses in order for those organizations that needs my product on a large number of machines. I would make contracts with the major machine producers and put a trial version of my product on their machines. After the trial version is up the consumer can order a product number and get the full version or purchase the product and use the idea that Microsoft uses with the installation of Microsoft Office and many of its other products and make it mandatory for the consumer to call in the product and get it registered. Since the product has to be registered every time it is installed it can be sold, but remember that it is limited to the amount of uses. This is how I would handle my distribution issues.

An important part of our world today is the education of the generations that will lead in the future of this country and the world. Nothing is given away free but in order to see how well my product works I would select a few high schools and universities throughout the country to give the product a test drive. If it works out as well as I would hope then the price would drop for educational institutes and nonprofit organizations and eventually the public. I see how Microsoft has expanded throughout the world and I would expect for nothing less than what they have achieved.

Another no brainer for any successful developer is for no one to copy or change and sell my work. In no case should my product be changed in any way without the permission my permission, which is the case with most software developers. Even though it happens every day I would hate for someone to make money off of what I have worked so hard for. There is really no way to protect my product besides leaving things up to the government and the copyright laws that I spoke of earlier. If I could possibly block any access to the code in my product then this could lead to the full protection of my product. Hopefully the code for my product is more difficult than what any one thief can comprehend.

One day I may be able to make these decisions with a product of my own, hopefully by that time the advancement of software protection would have improved even further and the theft of software has decreased dramatically. But until that day comes I will continue learn and plan.

Works Cited

Brinson, Diane and Radcliffe, Mark F. "Copyright Law." DLA Piper US LLP. 1999.
<http://library.findlaw.com/1999/Jan/1/241476.html>.

Scott, Brian. "Software Copyright Laws." 2 February, 2009.
<http://www.researchcopyright.com/article-software-copyright-laws.php>.

Jezreel Wilson

Prof. Underwood

COINS 431

10 September 2009

Grade: 80

Video Game Violence

Many people are quick to state that video games are the cause for so much of the violence going on in the world today. There might be some truth to that, and then again there are others that would strongly disagree.

All violent video games have a few things in common: they involve a constant hurting and/or killing of others, there is no punishment for killing, the more you kill the more you are rewarded, and the killings was almost always seen as justified. Even though people say more should be done to prevent the influence of violence through video games, a lot has already been started. The Entertainment Software Rating Board or ESRB have created ratings that “provide concise and impartial information about the content and age-appropriateness of games that you might consider purchasing or renting for your children.” Every game that is produced for any console or platform goes through the ESRB and is branded with their rating on the back of the game’s case. ESRB has been highly successful with their award winning “OK to Play” campaign launched in 2003. ESRB’s “efforts help to increase awareness and use of the rating system so that parents can make informed computer and video game purchase decisions.” Since every game informs the consumer of the possible violence entailed in the game it then comes to the buyer of the product to make the responsible decision. The more violent games are rated M (mature) and you must be 17 or older to purchase this product. There are also family settings on systems such as the Xbox 360 and PS3 that allow games with certain ratings not to be played on the system without a password being entered. So in the end all the responsibility is really on the shoulders of the consumers.

I really don’t think that there is too much more to be done about violence in video games without going to the extreme. As a video gamer I love the graphics and game play that video

games provide. The one thing that could possibly decrease the use of M rated games is to increase the prices; the more violent it is the more it costs. Something else that could be done would be to eliminate violence in video games all together, which quite frankly would hurt the gaming industry dramatically because the consumers would have a change of interest for the lack of realism. This would be the most extreme punishment next to eliminating the sale of violent video games or video games altogether.

But maybe instead of thinking about the typical violent video games, such as Grand Theft Auto and Smackdown vs. Raw, think of Call of Duty and any of the Tom Clancy games. These games focus on being a hero and the everyday life of a soldier fighting for their country. Call of Duty actually is based on the history of wars that have been fought in the past 200 years and actually tell the stories of survivors. Maybe these so called violent games teach us more than we expect, but we are human and see what we want to see. In fact, the same video games are sold here in the United States as overseas and statistics show “the number of youth violence overseas is noticeably lower than that of the United States.” Some researchers have found that even though “evidence from brain scans carried out while gamers play also seem to support a connection between playing video games and activation of regions of the brain associated with aggression,” “there is no obvious link between real-world violence statistics and the advent of video games.” Statistics show that while the number of violent video games continues to increase year after year, the number of violent crimes have steadily decreased. In 2005, “there were 1,360,088 violent crimes reported in the USA compared with 1,423,677 the year before,” even though the this study has not been fully proven this provides some evidence that violence in video games has little to do with violent crimes.

Even though lots of blame have been put on the video gaming industry for the violence due to their product, it is still the responsibility of the player to make the right decision. No one is threatening or forcing anyone to do anything, it is your choice if you want to buy a game just as it is your choice if you want to imitate what you do in a game. As I said earlier, as in games, it is all on the shoulders of the player.

Works Cited

Farrales, Bernard. Violence in Video Games. 6 September 2009.

<http://cseserv.engr.scu.edu/StudentWebPages/BFarrales/ResearchPaper.htm>.

Entertainment Software Rating Board. Education and Outreach. 6 September 2009.

<http://www.esrb.org/about/education.jsp>.

The Lion and Lamb Project. 2004. Media Violence- Video Games. 7 September 2009.

http://www.lionlamb.org/media_violence_video_games.htm.

ScienceDaily. 15 May 2008. Could Violent Video Games Reduce Rather Than Increase

Violence? 6 September 2009.

<http://www.sciencedaily.com/releases/2008/05/080514213432.htm>.

Linux on Xbox 360

COIN431

Grade: 100

Linux on Xbox 360

Jezreel Wilson

- System Components
- Applying Linux
- Requirements
- Kernel
- Security

Hardware

- 3-core **PowerPC**, 3.2 GHz
- **512 MB** of RAM
- 500 MHz **ATI** graphics
- (optional) hard drive
- **DVD** drive
- 3x **USB 2.0**
- 100 MBit **Ethernet**
- **TV, VGA, optional HDMI** support

How is this possible?

- A vulnerability found in the system.
 - Allows running of arbitrary code.
- **Xbox 360 Update Killing Homebrew**
 - **849x System Update**
 - Overwrites the vital boot block

Taking back Your 360

2 Ways of Getting back control

- Avoid getting the Update
 - Don't update your system to the latest software
- A complete end user compatible hack
 - Planned to be released on free60.org shortly

Requirements for Linux

- A machine running a Linux based OS
- Sources for the Linux Kernel version 2.6.21
- Xenon patchset
- Binutils (targeting the powerpc architecture)
- GCC (targeting the powerpc architecture)

Kernel

To run linux, you need to use the Linux Bootloader available right now. To compile the kernel, you need to set up a cross compiler toolchain (unless you already have another PowerPC Linux machine).

Hypervisor

Responsible for encryption, decryption and the enforcement of access restrictions on memory.

- http://www.free60.org/Main_Page
- **Free60** is a project towards porting GNU/Linux, BSD, Darwin and related open-source operating systems to the Microsoft Xbox 360 video game console.

- http://www.xbox-linux.org/wiki/Main_Page

Windows 7 Biometrics

COIN431

Grade: 100

Windows 7 Biometrics

By: Jezreel Wilson

Biometrics?

Biometrics relies on measuring an unchanging physical characteristic of a person to uniquely identify that person.

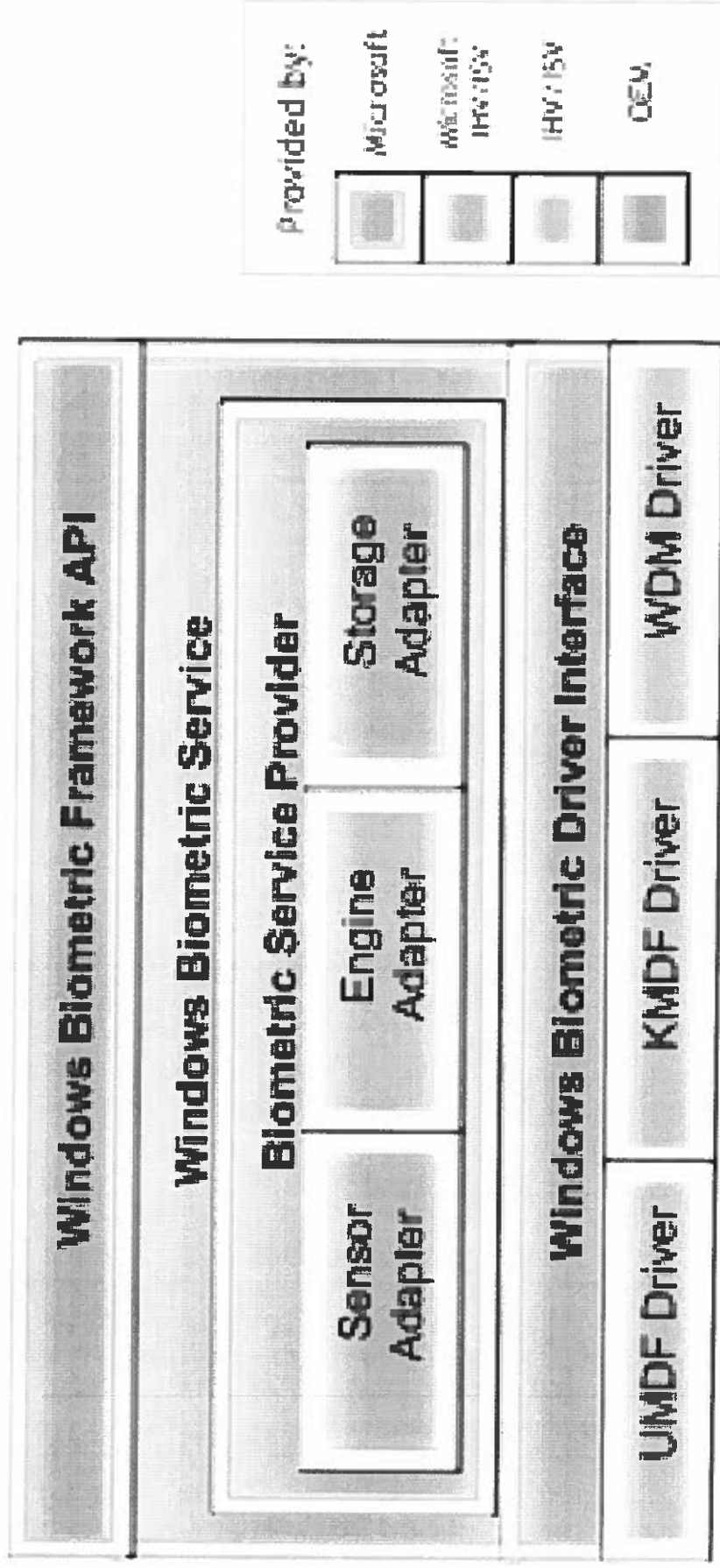
What's New for Windows 7

- Common Management Platform
 - Windows Biometric Framework (WBF)
- Consistent User Experience
- Everything Works Together

Windows Biometric Framework (WBF)

The Windows operating system provides native support for fingerprint biometric devices through WBF.

Windows Biometric Framework Cont.



Windows Biometric Framework

Components

- Windows Biometric Driver Interface (WBDI)
 - provides a common interface
- Windows Biometric Service (WBS)
 - Manages fingerprint biometric devices through WBDI drivers that are installed on the system.
 - Biometric Unit
- WBF API
 - Allows applications to enroll, identify, and verify user identities

Work Cite

- White Paper available from
 - <http://www.windows7update.com/Windows7-Biometrics.html>